

Curriculum Vitae

Saviour Christopher Effiong, PhD

ORCID: <https://orcid.org/0009-0005-0367-7054>

Address: Sukuta, The Gambia | Phone: +220 2038059, +2348109591832

Email: saviour.chris@saaingo.org, effiongsaviour70@gmail.com

Interdisciplinary researcher bridging Educational Psychology, Sociology and Data Science. PhD-qualified in human behavioural dynamics, with certified technical training in data science (Python, machine learning, NLP). Expertise in quantitative and qualitative research methodologies, psychometrics and socio-pedagogical frameworks, currently focused on AI transparency, fairness and pedagogical effectiveness in behavioural-science applications.

Professional Experience

Lead Researcher, SAAI Institute of Education and Capacity Development, Nigeria | 10/03/26 – present

Part-Time Lecturer, Department of Psychological Foundations of Education, University of Uyo, Nigeria | 25/05/2026 – present

- Courses: Introduction to Teaching and Educational Foundations; Curriculum and Teaching Methods Strategies; Educational Technology; Determinants of Behaviour.

Lead Researcher, SAAI Institute of Education and Capacity Development, Nigeria | 08/01/2026.

Lecturer (Part-Time), Department of Psychological Foundations of Education, University of Uyo, Nigeria | 26/05/2026.

- Courses: Introduction to Teaching and Educational Foundations, Curriculum and Teaching Methods Strategies, Educational Technology and Determinants of Behaviour.

Principal Lecturer / Head of Department — Goshen Wills College of Education, Nigeria | 02/08/2019 – 9/12/2025.

- **Documented academic career break, [06/02/2022] – [19/11/2025]** — Primary Caregiver responsibilities, medical certificate attested to it. **[This break falls within continued formal employment and it has interrupted the employment period. The leave of absence approvals (without payments) by the Rector refers. The total interrupted months were 45].**
- Delivered teaching and mentorship to students and junior faculty; oversaw departmental administration and curriculum development and reviews.
- Coordinated project-defence protocols and supervised numerous undergraduate/PGDE research projects.
- Delivered individual and group educational counselling services.
- Organised orientation programmes for newly admitted students; collaborated on workshops/conferences; performed journal reviews.
- Courses taught: Psychology of Learning, Developmental Psychology, Intelligence, Attitudes, Research Methods in Education, Behaviour Modification, Psychological Testing, Creative Experiences for Children.

Volunteer Research Assistant (Remote) — Diversity Watch Limited, UK | [29/07/2018 – [30/09/2019

Senior Researcher/Instructor | Corporate Institute of Research and Computer Science | Akwa Ibom StatE, Nigeria | 17/12/27 – 26/11/2020.

Part-Time Lecturer — University of Education, Winneba, Ghana (AKS Study Centre) | [19/06/2014 – [17/12/2015

Lecturer I — Metropolitan Polytechnic, Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria | [16/06/2014 – [24/08/2017

- Courses: Introduction to Psychology, Social Philosophy, Sociology, Personnel Management, Research Methods, Purchasing Management.

Supervisory Councillor for Education — Uyo Local Government Council, Nigeria | [21/08/2009 – [26/02/2010]

Education

- Certificate in Agentic Artificial Intelligence | Xaltius Academy, Singapore | 2026 (On-going_
- Certificate in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence | Xaltius Academy, Singapore | 2025 - 2026
- PhD in Educational Psychology | University of Uyo, Nigeria | 2014 – 2017

Doctoral Thesis: Home Interpersonal Relations and Social Adaptability of Students in Schools.

- M.Ed in Educational Psychology | University of Calabar, Nigeria | 2009 - 2014.
Master's Thesis: Domestic Violence and Married Teachers Tasks' Performance in Schools
- B.Sc. in Sociology | Imo State University, Nigeria | 2015 - 2018.
- B.Ed. in Education Guidance and Counselling | Imo State University, Nigeria | 2009 - 2013.

Other qualifications

- Higher Diploma in Marketing Management — Chartered Institute of Commerce of Nigeria, Lagos [2002–2004]
- Higher Diploma in Human Resources Management Technology — Federal University of Technology, Owerri, Nigeria [2001–2004]
- Diploma in Data Processing and Application — Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, Nigeria [1998–1999]
- **Senior School Certificate (SSCE) | 2005**

Publications and Other Research Outputs

Peer-reviewed journal articles, listed most recent first, with a brief note on scientific significance:

- ◆ Effiong, S. C. (2026). Investigating AI-Supported Learning Analytics for Enhancing Developmental Outcomes of Students in Nigerian Schools: A Mixed Methods Study. *SSR Journal of Artificial Intelligence (SSRJAI)*, 3(6), 78–91. Open access.
- ◆ Effiong, S. C. (2026). Exploring Artificial Intelligence (AI) Adoptions in Psychology Research: Opportunities, Challenges and Strategies for Enhancing Effective Integration. *GAS Journal of Arts Humanities and Social Science*, 4(4), 64–80. Open access.
- ◆ Effiong, S. C. (2019). Parental Deprivation and Social Adaptability of Secondary School Adolescent Students in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *Intercontinental Journal of Education*, 3(1). Open access
- ◆ Archibong, G. A. & Effiong, S. C. (2018). Teacher qualities as a predictor of students' moral values in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *Journal of Educational Benchmarks*, 7(1), 44 – 51. (Peer Reviewed). Available online at: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/371988209_Teacher_Qualities_as_a_Predictor_of_Students%27_Moral_Values_in_Secondary_Schools_in_Akwa_Ibom_Nigeria
- ◆ Effiong, S. C., Uyanga, U. D., & Udosen, E. J. (2018). Teachers' creative practices as predictors of innovative learning behaviours of Secondary School students in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *International Journal of Education Development*, 22(3), 34 – 43. (Peer Reviewed)
- ◆ Effiong, S.C., Obushi, L. O. & Adebola, A. J. (2018). Teachers' assessment indices and total quality management principles of education in Primary Schools in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *Nigerian Journal of Educational Research and Evaluation*, 17, 1, 72 – 84. (Peer Reviewed)
- ◆ Uyanga, U. D. & Effiong, S. C. (2017). Family patriarchy and self-reliant development among Students in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *Global Journal of Human-Social Science G: Linguistics & Education*, 17(6): 53 – 58. (Peer Reviewed) https://globaljournals.org/GJHSS_Volume17/6-Family-Patriarchy-and-Self.pdf
- ◆ Effiong, S. C., Okoro, C. C. & Ewara, A. M (2017). Value re-orientation and national development among Students in Secondary Schools in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *Journal of Social Science*, 14(1): 49 – 53.
- ◆ Effiong, S. C. & Okoro, C. C. (2016). Psychological and economic value orientation and social adjustment of students in Universities in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *GASPRO Journal of Eminent Scholars*, 1,1, 76 – 70. <http://www.globalacademicstars.com/article/psychological-and-economic-value-orientations-and-social-adjustment-of-students-in-universities-in-akwa-ibom-state-nigeria-saviour-c-e-cornelius-c-o>
- ◆ Effiong, S. C. & Akpan, R. W. (2016). Vocationalisation of education for self-reliance among students in Akwa Ibom State. *Journal of Education*, 9(1): 140 – 151.
- ◆ Okoro, C. C. & Effiong, S. C. (2016). Academic Self-Concept and Cheating Behaviour of Students in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *European Journal of Education and Applied Psychology*, 3, 58–62.
- ◆ Effiong, S. C. & Okoro, C. C. (2016). Psychological and Economic Value Orientation and Social Adjustment of Students in Universities in Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria. *GASPRO Journal of Eminent Scholars*, 1(1), 70–76.

Software / data outputs

- Credit & Portfolio Risk Modelling ("Saviour Project") — end-to-end classification model for high-risk loan borrowers (Random Forest, XGBoost, SMOTE for class imbalance, SHAP for explainability). Repository: github.com/saviourchris/credit-risk-predictive-modelling

Significance: demonstrates applied, explainable machine-learning practice directly transferable to fairness auditing of algorithmic systems.

- Electric Vehicle Market and Trend Analytics — multi-source data pipeline (Python, SQL, Tableau) for market-trend and consumer-behaviour analysis.

Significance: applied data-pipeline and dashboarding experience supporting large-scale behavioural/financial dataset analysis.

Conference Presentations and International Advanced Schools

- Effiong, S. C. & Obushi, A. L. Developing and Validating a Scale to Measure Knowledge Economy Competencies for Sustainable Development of Nigerian Higher Education (oral). 6-Day Annual International Forum Conference and Workshop, Association of Behavioural Research Analysts and Psychometricians (AB-ReAP), Faraba Campus, University of The Gambia. **[DD/MM/2026 (04–09 May 2026)]**.
- Effiong, S. C. Evaluating the Cultural Nuance of LLMs for Health Promotion in Gambia: An Algorithmic Auditing Approach (oral, upcoming). 9th Africa Regional Congress, International Council for Health, Physical Education, Recreation, Sport and Dance (ICHPER-SD) Africa Region, Banjul, The Gambia. **[23–25 September 2026]**.
- Effiong, S. C., Uyanga, U. D. & Udosen, E. J. Teachers' Creative Practices as Predictors of Innovative Learning Behaviours (oral). 3rd Annual International Conference of the Forum of Educational Benchmarks in Nigeria, University of Uyo Town Campus. **[03–06 April 2018]**.
- Effiong, S. C., Obushi, L. O. & Adebola, A. J. Teachers' Assessment Indices and Total Quality Management Principles of Education (oral). 19th Annual International Conference of the Association of Educational Researchers and Evaluators of Nigeria (ASSEREN), Skye Bank Hall, University of Jos. **[10–14 July 2017]**.
- Effiong, S. C., Okoro, C. C. & Ewara, A. M. Value Re-orientation and National Development (oral). 6th International Conference of the Social Sciences, Ignatius Ajuru University of Education, Rivers State. **[14–17 August 2016]**.

Organisation of International Conferences

- Member of the Local Organising Committee (hospitality and logistics team) — 9th Africa Regional Congress, ICHPER-SD Africa Region, Banjul, The Gambia. **[23–25 September 2026]**.
- Member of the organising body, Association of Behavioural Research Analysts and Psychometricians (AB-ReAP) — 6-Day Annual International Forum Conference and Workshop, Faraba Campus, University of The Gambia. **[04–09 May 2026]**.
- Organising Committee Member/Collaborator — 2nd National Conference of the Schools of Education, Goshen Wills College of Education. **[26–28 November 2025.]** (National, not international — included for completeness; confirm whether to keep given the call's international focus.)

Participation in Industrial Innovation

Applied capstone projects in credit-risk modelling and EV market analytics (see Software/data outputs below under complementary skills) represent applied, industry-facing data-science work or at:

<https://github.com/saviourchris/credit-risk-predictive-modelling/blob/main/README.md>

Prizes and Awards

- Fellow, Social Science Research Council (SSRC), USA. **[DD/MM/2019]**.
- *Significance: international, competitively awarded fellowship supporting interdisciplinary social-science research, validating expertise in behavioural and sociological inquiry.*

Funding Received

- Project: Evaluation of Institutional Teaching Competence and Environmental Moderating Constraints in Gambian Basic and Secondary Education: A Multi-Tiered Quality Assurance Diagnostic Framework.
- Role: Project Leader / Principal Investigator. Institution: Deeper Life Schools Network (The Gambia). Reference: DLS/QAF/2026/087-GM. Programme: National Research and Quality Assurance Initiatives (NRQAI). Budget: GMD 120,000. Duration: 3 months **[DD/MM/2026 – DD/MM/2026]**.
- Designed a multi-tiered quality-assurance framework and directed field research across the Kotu, Old Yundum and Brikama clusters (primary n=66, secondary n=92 cohorts). Matched MoBSE quantitative scales against qualitative environmental logs; managed the Post-Observation Reflective Dialogue (PORD)

loop and secured verified sign-off from 158 instructors; performed statistical aggregation and diagnostic modelling in Python to produce the intervention framework and professional-development plan.

Supervision and Mentoring.

- ❑ **Institutional Context:** University of Education, Weneba, Ghana (2014 – 2015), Goshen Wills College of Education (2019 – 2025), University of Uyo (2026).
- ❑ **Target Group:** Undergraduate and PGDE Students and junior faculty members.
- ❑ **Key Responsibilities:**
 - Supervised numerous student research projects, driving high-quality academic outcomes.
 - Provided continuous formative feedback to improve students' academic and research writing skills.
 - Coordinated departmental undergraduate project defense protocols in collaboration with academic staff.
 - Delivered individualised and group educational counselling services to guide students' academic pathways.
- ❖ **Teaching activities**
 - ❑ **University Level (2014-2015, 2026):** Part-Time Lecturer at the University of Education, Ghana (courses: Introduction to Psychology, Psychology of Learning, Teaching Competencies, Research Methods in Education), and University of Uyo, Nigeria, instructing courses including Introduction to Teaching and Educational Foundations, Curriculum and Teaching Methods Strategies, Educational Technology and Determinants of Behaviour.
 - ❑ **Higher Education Level (2019 – 2025):** Principal Lecturer at Goshen Wills College of Education, teaching Psychology of Learning, Developmental Psychology, Attitudes, Research Methods in Education, Behaviour Modification, Psychological Testing and Creative Experiences in Children.
 - ❑ **Polytechnic Level (2014 – 2017):** Part-Time Lecturer at Metropolitan Polytechnic, Akwa Ibom State, Nigeria, teaching Introduction to Psychology, Social Philosophy, Sociology, Personnel Management, Research Methods and Purchasing Management..

Other Items of Interest

- ❑ Registered Teaching Licence: Licensed by the Teacher Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN), 2016.
- ❑ Professional Affiliations:
 - Member, Association of Behavioural Research Analysts and Psychometricians (AB-ReAP) | 2026.
 - Member, Forum of Educational Benchmarkers in Nigeria (FEBN) | 2019.
 - Member, Association of Educational Researchers and Evaluators of Nigeria (ASSEREN) | 2017.
 - Member, Nigerian Council of Educational Psychologists (NCEP) | 2016.
 - Chartered Member, Chartered Institute of Commerce of Nigeria (CICN) | 2004.
- ❖ **Complementary skills, (objective and verifiable)**
 - ❑ **Emotional Intelligence and Interpersonal Skills**
 - **Context of Acquisition:** Rooted in advanced doctoral training in Educational Psychology (2017) and practically refined through years of delivering individual and group educational counselling services.
 - **Application:** Exceptional capacity for active listening, conflict resolution and managing interpersonal dynamics. This skill is actively applied when mentoring junior faculty and guiding diverse student populations, fostering a collaborative, highly supportive and productive academic environment.
 - ❑ **Data Science, Machine Learning and NLP:**
 - **Context of Acquisition** – Formally acquired through rigorous specialised studies at **Xaltius Academy**, Singapore, culminating in a Certificate in **Data Science and Artificial Intelligence** (2025-2026) and on-going coursework in **Argentive Artificial Intelligence** (2026).
 - **Applied Capstone Projects:**
 - 1) **Saviour Project (Credit & Portfolio Risk Modelling)** – Developed and deployed an end-to-end predictive classification model to identify high-risk loan borrowers. Implemented Random Forest and XGBoost algorithms, resolved severe class imbalance using SMOTE, evaluated performance using Recall and AUC-ROC and applied SHAP for model explainability to ensure transparent, ethical decision-making.
 - 2) **Electric Vehicle Market and Trend Analytics** – Engineered a multi-source data pipeline using Python, SQL and Tableau to identify emerging market trajectories, consumer behaviour patterns and predictive product opportunities within the clean energy sector.
 - **Application:** Applied in active research pipelines to utilise Python, SQL, Tableau, and Power-BI for processing complex behavioural and financial datasets, transforming raw metrics into interactive executive dashboards and transparent algorithmic models. See my repository: <https://github.com/saviourchris/credit-risk-predictive-modelling/blob/main/README.md>

- ❑ **Research Management Skills:**
 - **Context of Acquisition:** Built over more than a decade of research design and execution, including doctoral and other trainings (PhD and M.Ed. in Educational Psychology; B.Sc in Sociology, B.Sc in Education Guidance and Counseling; HD in Marketing Management 2004, HD in HRM Technology, 2004; ND in Computer Programming and Data Processing, 1999, Certificate in Data Science & AI,) and professional roles as Senior Researcher at the Corporate Institute of Research and Computer Science (2016 – 2019) and Volunteer Research Assistant (Remote) at Diversity Watch Ltd, UK.
 - **Application:** Expert command over quantitative and qualitative methodologies, including the mastery of analytical tools such as SPSS, Excel, E-Views, NVivo and meta-analytical frameworks to design, manage and execute complex institutional and behavioural studies.
- ❑ **Communication Skills:**
 - **Context of Acquisition:** Refined through over 12 years of academic lecturing, presenting peer-reviewed papers at scientific conferences and delivering counselling and advisory services.
 - **Application:** Proven capability in translating highly technical data science and psychometric modelling concepts into accessible insights for non-technical stakeholders, university students and policy-makers. Experienced in writing peer-reviewed publications, technical reports and comprehensive research proposals including grant.
 - grant writing, technical reporting, mentorship, emotional intelligence and conflict resolution, departmental leadership
- ❑ **Organisational and Leadership Skills:**
 - **Context of Acquisition:** Developed during tenures as Head of Department at Goshen Wills College of Education (2019 – 2025) and as the Supervisory Counsellor for Education for the Uyo Local Government Area (2008 – 2009) where community resources and public educational policies were directly managed. Developed as the Lead Researcher at SAAI Institute of Education and Capacity Development by first training research assistants and supervising data collections process for the implementation of Deeper Life Schools Networks project in Gambia.
- ❑ **Other Job-Related Skills (Continuous Assessment and Educational Quality Assurance):**
 - **Context of Acquisition:** Developed during extensive practical pedagogical work as a Lead Researcher at SAAI Institute of Education and Capacity Development and through professional training workshops.
 - **Application:** Practical mastery in designing, calibrating and deploying standardised educational evaluation metrics, classroom observation forms and diagnostic continuous assessment frameworks to systematically measure teacher competencies and student learning outcomes.

Referees

- Professor Imaobong D. Akpan — Former Dean, Faculty of Education, University of Uyo, Nigeria.
Email: imaobongdakpan@uniuyo.edu.ng | Phone: +234-8023009246
- Professor Joshua O. Adeleke — School of Education, Faraba Campus, University of The Gambia.
Email: joadeleke@utg.edu.gm | Phone: +2205091469
- Dr. Clement Willie — Provost, Goshen Wills College of Education, Nigeria.
Email: clementwillie241@gmail.com | Phone: +234-23781635; +234-9039496514